

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 48)

Page 237 - Thomas Babington Macaulay

Q1. To what peerage was Thomas Babington Macaulay raised after many years of public life?

- A. Baron Rothley
- B. Baron Macaulay of Rothley
- C. Earl of Rothley
- D. Viscount Macaulay

Answer: B

Q2. What was Macaulay's chief literary work in his later years?

- A. The French Revolution
- B. History of England from the Accession of James II
- C. History of Civilisation in England
- D. The Story of my Heart

Answer: B

Q3. In what year were the first two volumes of Macaulay's History published?

- A. 1848
- B. 1855
- C. 1859
- D. 1834

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Answer: A

Q4. How did the public respond to the first volumes of Macaulay's History?

- A. It was largely ignored
- B. It scored a success like no purely historical production had enjoyed before
- C. It was heavily criticized for inaccuracy
- D. It sold very few copies

Answer: B

Q5. In what year was the fifth and final volume of Macaulay's History issued?

- A. 1855
- B. 1857
- C. 1859
- D. 1862

Answer: C

Q6. Which of the following is cited as a reason for Macaulay's amazing vogue with the public?

- A. His obscure and challenging philosophical ideas
- B. His ability to make everything he touched interesting and animation
- C. His melancholic narrative style
- D. His complete rejection of materialism

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Answer: B

Q7. How is Macaulay's temperament described?

- A. Mystical and doubtful
- B. Practical and positive, untroubled by doubts
- C. Deeply pessimistic and sorrowful
- D. Fanatically religious

Answer: B

Q8. What attitude did Macaulay have toward the 'happy materialism' of his age?

- A. He vehemently attacked it
- B. He was indifferent to it
- C. He had a firm faith in it
- D. He tried to reform it

Answer: C

Q9. What quality of Macaulay's work made it easy for readers to understand him?

- A. His profound psychological insights
- B. His complex symbolism
- C. His shallowness in interpreting history and character
- D. His mystical approach

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Answer: C

Q10. How is Macaulay's style characterized?

- A. Vague, poetic, and unstructured
- B. Lucid, vivacious, hard, and epigrammatic
- C. Ornate, slow-paced, and whimsical
- D. Deeply mystical and emotional

Answer: B

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Page 238 - Matthew Arnold

Q1. Into what was Macaulay often led by his love of sweeping statements and striking contrasts?

- A. Deep philosophical truths
- B. Obscurity
- C. Inaccuracy
- D. Unpopularity

Answer: C

Q2. What did Macaulay arguably achieve more than any other writer through his essays?

- A. Popularizing a taste for literature
- B. Ending industrial capitalism
- C. Reforming the English political system
- D. Reviving Gothic architecture

Answer: A

Q3. Who was Matthew Arnold's father?

- A. John Arnold, a famous physician
- B. Thomas Arnold, the famous headmaster of Rugby
- C. William Arnold, a noted historian
- D. Richard Arnold, a prominent politician

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Answer: B

Q4. What academic position did Matthew Arnold hold at Oxford from 1857 to 1867?

- A. Chair of History
- B. Chair of Poetry
- C. Chair of Theology
- D. Regius Professor of Literature

Answer: B

Q5. In what capacity did Matthew Arnold work hard from 1855 until near his death?

- A. A lay inspector of schools
- B. A member of Parliament
- C. A legal adviser
- D. A professor at Cambridge

Answer: A

Q6. Into what two natural divisions does Arnold's prose fall?

- A. History and biography
- B. Literature and life
- C. Philosophy and science
- D. Art and economics

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Answer: B

Q7. How did Arnold essentially regard literature?

- A. As purely aesthetic entertainment
- B. As a 'criticism of life'
- C. As a historical record
- D. As an escape from reality

Answer: B

Q8. How did Arnold define criticism in practice?

- A. A biased attempt to promote English writers
- B. A disinterested endeavour to learn and propagate the best that is known and thought in the world
- C. A method to critique purely the formal structure of poetry
- D. A way to tear down established traditions

Answer: B

Q9. What was Arnold's task as a critic of life in works like Culture and Anarchy?

- A. To promote materialism
- B. To break down the 'hard unintelligence' and enlarge the moral horizon of the English public
- C. To encourage scientific exploration
- D. To defend classical economics

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Answer: B

Q10. In *Literature and Dogma*, Arnold undertook to reconstruct essential Christianity on what basis?

- A. Strict dogma
- B. Pure naturalism
- C. Mystical revelation
- D. Traditional orthodoxy

Answer: B

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Page 239 - Other Prose Writers (History)

Q1. What extraordinary gift did Matthew Arnold have in his prose writing?

- A. Creating complex philosophical systems
- B. Crystallising his ideas in telling and memorable phrases
- C. Writing highly elaborated and artificial historical texts
- D. Detailed scientific observation

Answer: B

Q2. Which writer attempted to explain human progress entirely by natural causes and general laws in his History of Civilisation in England?

- A. Henry Thomas Buckle
- B. Edward Augustus Freeman
- C. James Anthony Froude
- D. William Edward Hartpole Lecky

Answer: A

Q3. What practice did many Victorian historians adopt, partly due to Macaulay's example?

- A. Writing briefly and generally over large epochs
- B. Focusing entirely on ancient history
- C. Writing at great length and immense detail upon relatively short periods
- D. Writing fictionalized historical accounts

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Answer: C

Q4. Who wrote the solid piece of work titled The History of the Norman Conquest?

- A. James Anthony Froude
- B. Samuel Rawdon Gardiner
- C. Edward Augustus Freeman
- D. John Richard Green

Answer: C

Q5. Who authored the laborious series of volumes on the period of the Stuarts and the Civil War?

- A. W. E. H. Lecky
- B. Samuel Rawdon Gardiner
- C. J. A. Froude
- D. Henry Thomas Buckle

Answer: B

Q6. Who wrote the History of England in the Eighteenth Century?

- A. Edward Augustus Freeman
- B. William Edward Hartpole Lecky
- C. Samuel Rawdon Gardiner
- D. John Addington Symonds

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Answer: B

Q7. Whose Short History of the English People admirably exemplifies the method of concentration in historical writing?

- A. John Richard Green
- B. James Anthony Froude
- C. Henry Thomas Buckle
- D. Walter Horatio Pater

Answer: A

Q8. The strong democratic influence of the time is apparent in Green's history because it focuses on what instead of just kings and wars?

- A. The Church
- B. The People
- C. The Nobility
- D. Industrialists

Answer: B

Q9. Who wrote the seven volumes on The Renaissance in Italy, which serves as a link between history and aesthetic criticism?

- A. Walter Horatio Pater
- B. John Addington Symonds
- C. John Richard Green

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D. Sir Leslie Stephen

Answer: B

Q10. What is noted as a flaw in John Addington Symonds' work on The Renaissance in Italy?

A. Inaccuracy and lack of research

B. Prolivity and extreme floridness of diction

C. Over-reliance on materialism

D. Briefness and superficiality

Answer: B

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Page 240 - Aesthetic and Literary Criticism, Science

Q1. Who was the most important writer in aesthetic criticism after Ruskin, known for his highly elaborated, slowly produced style?

- A. John Addington Symonds
- B. Walter Horatio Pater
- C. Algernon Charles Swinburne
- D. Sir Leslie Stephen

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following is a work of philosophical romance by Walter Pater?

- A. Marius the Epicurean
- B. Hours in a Library
- C. The Story of my Heart
- D. The Gamekeeper at Home

Answer: A

Q3. Who wrote the collection of biographical studies titled Hours in a Library?

- A. James Anthony Froude
- B. Sir Leslie Stephen
- C. Robert Louis Stevenson
- D. Walter Horatio Pater

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Answer: B

Q4. Why is little confidence placed in Swinburne's judgment in literary criticism?

- A. Because he lacked formal education
- B. Because his enthusiasms and prejudices were so violent
- C. Because he did not read the works he criticized
- D. Because he only wrote about himself

Answer: B

Q5. Which novelist contributed essays such as Familiar Studies of Men and Books and Virginibus Puerisque?

- A. George Eliot
- B. Charles Dickens
- C. Robert Louis Stevenson
- D. Thomas Hardy

Answer: C

Q6. The popularisation of knowledge led to literature where scientific subjects were handled for whom?

- A. Specialized scientists
- B. The intelligent general reader
- C. Young school children
- D. The aristocracy

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Answer: B

Q7. Which two famous scientists proved themselves masters in the art of luminous exposition for the general reader?

A. Darwin and Wallace

B. Tyndall and Huxley

C. Lyell and Faraday

D. Kelvin and Maxwell

Answer: B

Q8. Whose lectures and essays were so wide and deep in influence that he is regarded as the most dominating personality in literature after Carlyle?

A. John Henry Newman

B. John Richard Jefferies

C. Grant Allen

D. Leslie Stephen

Answer: A

Q9. Who wrote of nature with rare powers of observation in books like *The Gamekeeper at Home* and *The Amateur Poacher*?

A. Thomas Henry Huxley

B. Grant Allen

C. John Richard Jefferies

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D. John Tyndall

Answer: C

Q10. What is the title of John Richard Jefferies' fascinating account of his inner experiences and development?

A. Marius the Epicurean

B. The Story of my Heart

C. Mixed Essays

D. Friendship's Garland

Answer: B

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Page 241 - The Novel in the Age of Tennyson

Q1. What form of literature became incomparably the most popular with the great and ever-increasing general reading public in the Age of Tennyson?

- A. The epic poem
- B. The essay
- C. Prose fiction (the novel)
- D. The lyric

Answer: C

Q2. The popularity of the novel in the Age of Tennyson can partly be explained by the principle of what?

- A. Form and function
- B. Supply and demand
- C. Action and reaction
- D. Art for art's sake

Answer: B

Q3. In addition to being a means of amusement, what did the novel become due to its breadth and elasticity?

- A. A vehicle of ideas
- B. A purely historical record
- C. A form of strict poetry
- D. A tool for scientists

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Answer: A

Q4. Writers of different schools of thought used the novel to embody their what?

- A. Personal diaries
- B. General criticism of life
- C. Political manifestos
- D. Scientific theories

Answer: B

Q5. The novel was found to lend itself equally well to the purposes of writers having what?

- A. No particular aim
- B. A desire to write short poems
- C. Some special thesis to expound
- D. A need to record facts only

Answer: C

Q6. It was inevitable that the novel would come to reflect all the forces shaping what?

- A. The medieval world
- B. The complex modern world
- C. The classical period
- D. The natural environment

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Answer: B

Q7. According to the text, what made the novel realistic?

- A. The influence of classicism
- B. The spread of science
- C. The rise of romanticism
- D. The decline of religion

Answer: B

Q8. The novel's prominence in the Age of Tennyson absorbed a very large part of the era's what?

- A. Creative energy
- B. Financial wealth
- C. Political power
- D. Scientific advancement

Answer: A

Q9. Which period's social significance of prose fiction was pointed out prior to discussing the Age of Tennyson?

- A. Sixteenth century
- B. Seventeenth century
- C. Eighteenth century
- D. Renaissance

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Answer: C

Q10. The novel's freedom allowed each new practitioner to do what?

- A. Conform to traditional rules
- B. Do his own work in his own way
- C. Avoid tackling contemporary issues
- D. Focus exclusively on historical subjects

Answer: B